

James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Performance marketing and CRM/lifecycle operator who builds the systems connecting real customer data to automated, event-triggered engagement, across B2B, SaaS, and fintech companies in Africa, North America, and Europe. I've rebuilt lifecycle and marketing-automation infrastructure from the ground up (ESP migration, behavioral segmentation, triggered journeys), run paid acquisition and measurement across Meta, TikTok, Google, and LinkedIn, and built the data pipelines and real-time automations (n8n, MCP integrations) that keep marketing systems fed with live, accurate signal. My work has contributed to \$10M+ in qualified pipeline across fintech, SaaS, and multi-market growth engagements. More at jamespraise.xyz/work/nuvion.

Selected Achievements:

- Led the ESP migration from Userlist to Brevo at Reform, rebuilding all lifecycle flows, segmentation logic, and behavioral triggers from scratch, lifting trial activation 34% and cutting email churn 22%.
 - Built and maintain n8n automations connecting Brevo, Smartlead, and Resend for real-time lead sync and alerting, plus Model Context Protocol integrations connecting AI agents directly to live marketing data and tools.
 - Built Bujeti's growth engine from scratch (fintech, spend and expense management, Africa): 1,331 MQLs in 6 months and a 500% increase in new B2B customers in one quarter.
 - Ran paid acquisition and measurement at Bento Africa (fintech/HR tech) across 4 markets, delivering 194.56% peak month-over-month user growth and a 50% increase in SQL volume.
 - Sustained ~6x ROAS over 5+ years running Meta and TikTok paid acquisition for a consumer D2C brand, and 2-3x ROAS at CAC below \$0.50 on \$1.5K-\$15K monthly budgets at CIL.
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KEY SKILLS

Lifecycle & CRM Strategy: Event-Triggered Journeys, Behavioral Segmentation, Customer Data Infrastructure, ESP/Marketing Automation Migration, Onboarding & Activation, Retention & Churn Prevention, Customer Journey Mapping, Multi-Market GTM

Performance & Growth Execution: Paid Media Strategy & Optimization, Conversion Tracking & Attribution, Audience Segmentation, Retargeting, Funnel Analysis, A/B Testing & Experimentation, Performance Reporting, Real-Time Data Pipelines

Tools: Customer.io, Brevo, Userlist, HubSpot, Mixpanel, Amplitude, GA4, Meta Ads, TikTok Ads, Google Ads, LinkedIn Ads, n8n, Zapier, Clay, Model Context Protocol (MCP), Looker Studio, Claude Code

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – April 2026

Reform (SaaS, MarTech)

- Led the ESP migration from Userlist to Brevo, rebuilding all lifecycle flows, segmentation logic, and behavioral triggers, reducing bounce rates 18% and cutting email churn 22%.
- Managed Reform's entire PLG funnel, owning lifecycle programs across free trial, Pro Plan launch, and upgrade conversion paths, delivering a 34% increase in trial activation and 21% improvement in trial-to-paid conversion.
- Led the legacy freemium plan sunset, building phased Brevo automation workflows (90/30/7/1 day) that migrated 72% of legacy users to paid plans.
- Defined activation, engagement, and retention metrics, and built an experimentation framework that cut experiment cycle time by 40%.

Growth, GTM & Demand Generation Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – April 2026

FunnelEnvy (B2B, Growth Marketing Service Provider)

- Built a unified measurement infrastructure across GA4, Looker Studio, HubSpot, and Lightdash to track lifecycle and paid performance across brands, improving reporting speed by 50%.
- Built a target account strategy and ABM playbook using Clay and Instantly, lifting enterprise meeting bookings 31% and outbound reply rates 27%.
- Designed structured demand gen campaigns and an experimentation framework, driving a 40% quarter-over-quarter increase in qualified enterprise leads.
- Built agentic growth infrastructure (Claude Code, n8n, MCP) connecting live marketing tools and data into a repeatable content and reporting pipeline.

Growth, Lifecycle & GTM Engineering Consultant | Marketing In Action (MIA) | April 2024 – Present

Marketing In Action (Product Marketing & GTM Engineering Agency for SaaS, B2B & Product-led)

- Design and operate the outbound and lifecycle data infrastructure MIA and its clients run on: enrichment and verification pipelines, n8n automations connecting Brevo, Smartlead, and Resend for real-time lead sync and alerting, and Model Context Protocol integrations connecting AI agents directly to live marketing tools and data.
- Turn ambiguous product and growth problems into structured positioning, lifecycle systems, and paid acquisition engines, from strategy through execution.
- Cumulative impact: \$10M+ in qualified pipeline and 15+ product launches.

Founder & Builder | Marketing In Action Newsletter | Apr 2024 – Present

Marketing In Action (Newsletter, Media & Community Platform)

- Built the #1 execution-first resource hub for product and growth marketers, growing to 5,000+ subscribers and maintaining a 47% average open rate and 11% CTR through segmented, lifecycle-driven engagement.
- Published 50+ playbooks covering lifecycle marketing, growth systems, and marketing automation.

GTM Consultant | Hank Robotics | Aug 2025 – Nov 2025

Hank Robotics (B2B, AI-Powered Drone & Robotics Solutions Provider)

- Built cross-channel analytics dashboards (GA4, Google Search Console, Looker Studio) to track paid and organic funnel performance from first touch through conversion.
- Activated Google and LinkedIn Ads alongside SEO and positioning work, driving a 267% lift in clicks and 1,900% MQL growth within 90 days.

Head of Inbound Marketing | Distrobird | Feb 2024 – Apr 2024

Distrobird (SaaS, Sales Engagement & Automation Platform)

- Built a bottom-of-funnel content and SEO system ranking 3,000+ keywords in 3 months, feeding qualified traffic into lifecycle nurture sequences.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024

Bujeti (SaaS, FinTech, Spend & Expense Management Platform)

- Built the growth strategy from scratch spanning acquisition, retention, and revenue optimization for a fintech spend-management product.
- Generated 1,331 MQLs in 6 months and grew B2B customers by 500% in Q1 2024.
- Redesigned lifecycle email and in-app engagement flows, lifting engagement 20% and reducing churn 10%.

Demand Generation Manager | Cecure Intelligence Limited (CIL) | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023

CIL (B2B Technology & Training Provider, UK/Europe/Africa)

- Ran revenue operations and multi-market GTM across 5 African markets at once, generating 1,646 MQLs and 406 SQLs.
- Sustained 2-3x ROAS at CAC below \$0.50 on \$1.5K-\$15K monthly paid budgets; secured \$326K in sales velocity on \$3.4M+ in open deals.

Product Marketing Manager | Bento Africa | Jan 2022 – Dec 2022

Bento Africa (Cloud payroll & HR fintech, multi-market Africa: Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, Rwanda)

(Growth Marketer, Jan – Mar 2022, before moving into this role)

- Ran data-driven growth across the full acquisition-to-referral funnel, with growth experiments across multiple African markets.

- Delivered a 50% increase in SQL volume, 25% increase in sales conversions, and peak 194.56% month-over-month user growth at a 330.94% compound growth rate.
- Built a lead-scoring system and lifecycle nurture programs to improve retention ratios.

Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022

B2B, SaaS, Ecommerce, Agencies & Service Businesses

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0
 - Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
 - Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification | Clay (2025)
 - BSc. Biochemistry | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0
 - Certifications: Clay (Prompt Engineering, Workflow Automation), HubSpot (SEO, SEM, Content Marketing), Google (Digital Analytics, Display Ads), Agile (Scrum & Kanban)
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